

Creating a bone

To create a bone, go in the skeleton menu by choosing Animation in the dropdown box. In any of the Orthographic view that you click will give you a bones. Hit enter when you are done with it. If you click on the joint tool again, and click on bone that already exists, then you can start creating the child of that bone. A hierarchy will be formed when you create a bone from another bones. Always the first bone that is created is the parent and the rest are all children. Also, this parent can have multiple children. Bones can be manipulated by scaling, rotating and moving along the axis, although scaling is unnecessary. Although, when you move , scale or rotate the child bone the parent bone is not affected.

To parent an existing bone to another, select the bone (or multiple bones) that is going to be the child (or children), then select the bone to be the parent and press [P]. To unparent a bone, select the bone and press [Shift] + [P]. Bones are not geometry and usually are not viewed in-game (you can select an option in the Unreal editor to view the bones if you would like to troubleshoot). To name a bone, select it and go to its channel box (the right side with it's move, rotate, scale attributes) and select its name in the grey box under 'channels' (its default name should be joint#) and just type in a new name.

If you do not see the channel box you can select it by going into the menu. Always name your bones and name them in a way that you or anyone else working on the scene understands, this is also very important when you are doing weight mapping. If an error occurs, no one would know which bone was affected. Do not put spaces in your bone names. You can always parent, unparent rename bones in the hypergraph hierarchy. You can also unparent a child bone (or just about anything) in the outliner by clicking the middle button of your mouse and dragging outside the hierarchy.

Channel Box Functions

The channel box is where you can set exact numbers for a bones translate (position), rotation, scale, visibility, and other special attributes. This will show up on the right side of the screen when you select a bone. If it does not, you can access it by selecting in the menus: Display UI Elements Channel Box/Layer Editor. When you want to change the value of a bone's attribute, just select the number field to the right of the attribute, type in the value, and press enter. If you don't want to alter a certain attribute of a bone or mesh, you can hide and/or lock certain attributes. Just select the name of the